



PARISHRAM
2027

A THING OF BEAUTY

LECTURE : 09

English

Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir



Topics to be Covered

1

Warm-up Game

2

A Thing of Beauty

3

Quiz



When I got an e-mail asking for my password, I should have smelt a rat.

- A) To spot rats in a dark room
- B) To misunderstand a speaker
- ✓ C) To suspect a trick or a deceit
- D) To get confused

"Starting a new business with no prior experience is often a leap in the dark."

- A) To perform a secret ritual
- B) To jump after the sun has set
- ☒ C) To do something without being certain of the outcome and result
- D) To be afraid of the dark

A vibrant, stylized illustration of a pastoral landscape. In the foreground, there are yellow daffodils and pink roses. A small stream flows through the middle ground, surrounded by green grass and rocks. In the background, there are rolling hills, a large tree on the right, and a mountain range under a sunset sky with a full moon and birds. The title 'A Thing of Beauty' is written in a large, elegant, dark green serif font, with a decorative flourish under the word 'Beauty'.

A Thing of Beauty

— By —
John Keats

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

John Keats (1795–1821) was a British Romantic poet.

Of all the great poets of the early nineteenth century, John Keats (1795–1821) was the last to be born and the first to die. Although trained to be a surgeon, Keats decided to devote himself wholly to poetry.



Keats' secret, his power to sway and delight the readers, lies primarily in his gift for perceiving the world and living his moods and aspirations in terms of language.

Keats breathed his last in February 1821 at the age of twenty-six and is still rated among the greatest romantic poets of England.

John Keats



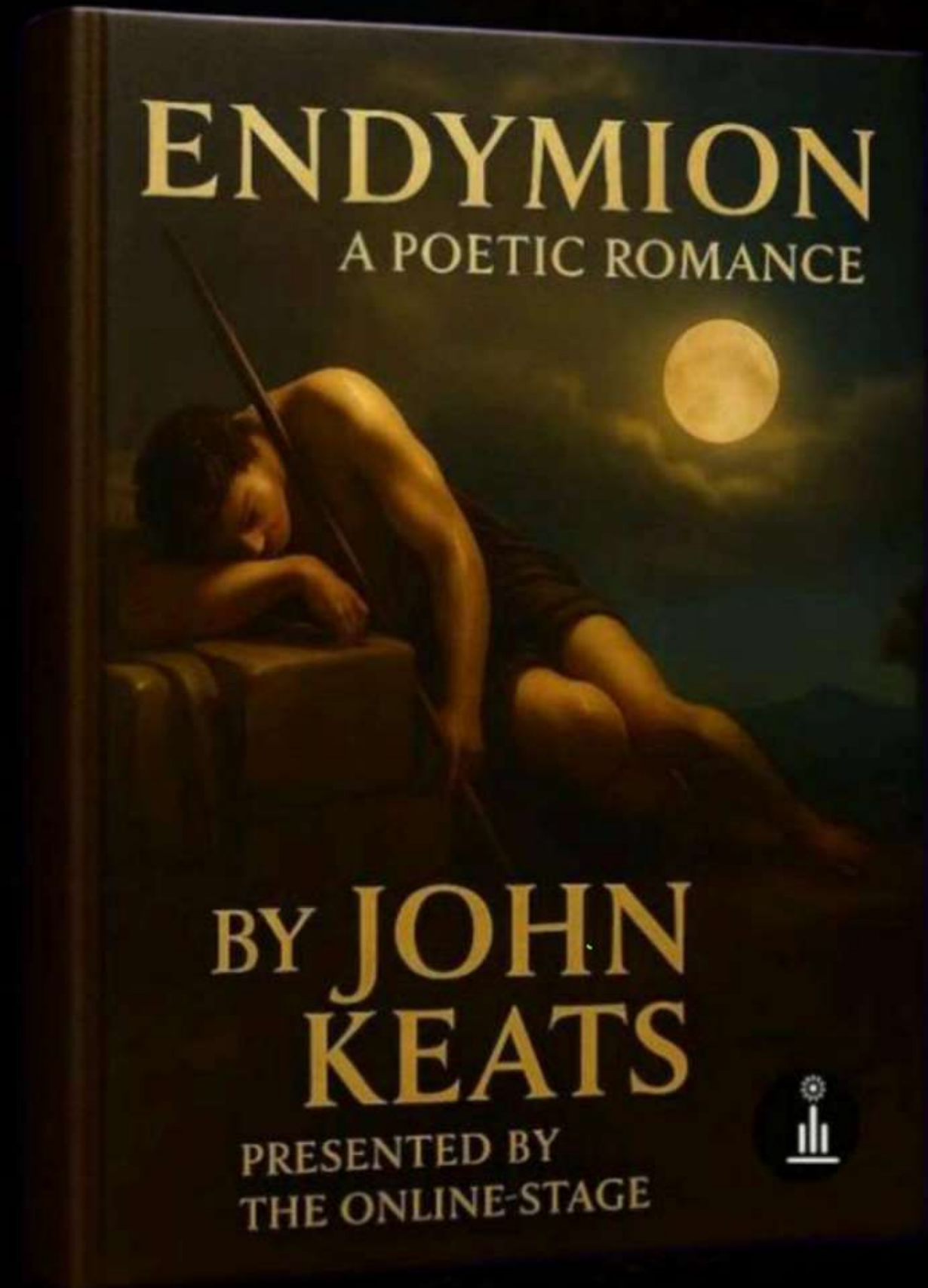
INTRODUCTION

- The theme of the poem rests in the opening line.
- A beautiful object is treasured in our mind because it provides us eternal and everlasting joy.
- This happiness never fades into nothingness but multiplies manifold whenever it flashes on our mind-screen.

ABOUT THE POEM

The following is an excerpt from the poem

'Endymion; A Poetic Romance'.



VIDEO

A thing of beauty is a joy forever

Its loveliness increases, it will never
charm

become meaningless
Pass into nothingness; but will keep



A bower quiet for us, and a sleep

Shade

Full of sweet dreams, and health,
and

Serenity, relaxation
quiet breathing.



Therefore, on every morrow, are

next day; tomorrow

we wreathing

Surround; encircle

a beautiful experience

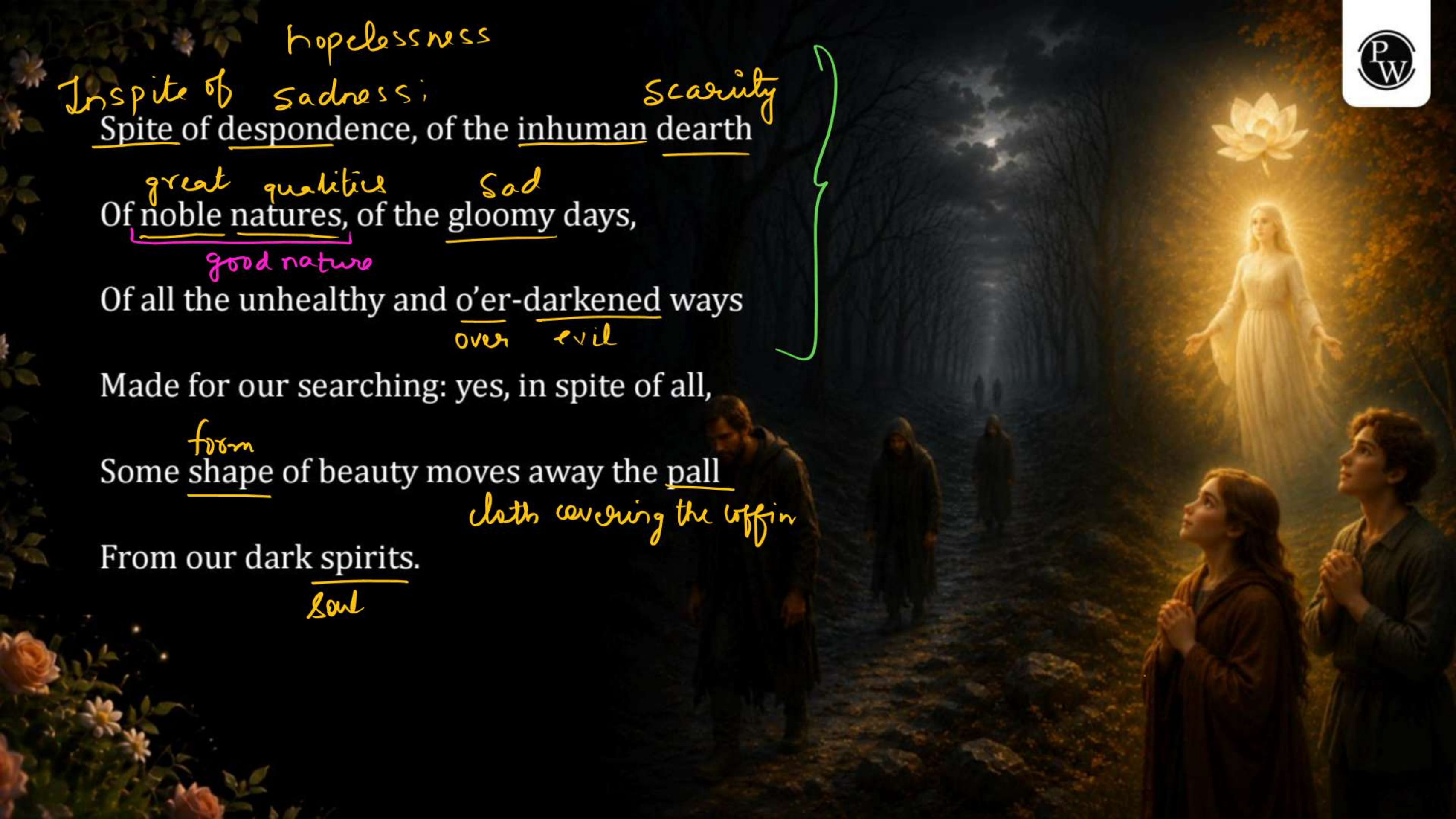
A flowery band to bind us to the

a garland of flower *↳ to connect
; to attach*

earth,



In spite of ^{hopelessness} sadness;
 Spite of despondence, of the inhuman ^{scarcity} dearth
 Of noble ^{great qualities} natures, of the ^{sad} gloomy days,
 Of all the unhealthy and ^{good nature} o'er-darkened ^{over evil} ways
 Made for our searching: yes, in spite of all,
 Some ^{form} shape of beauty moves away the pall
 From our dark spirits.
^{soul}



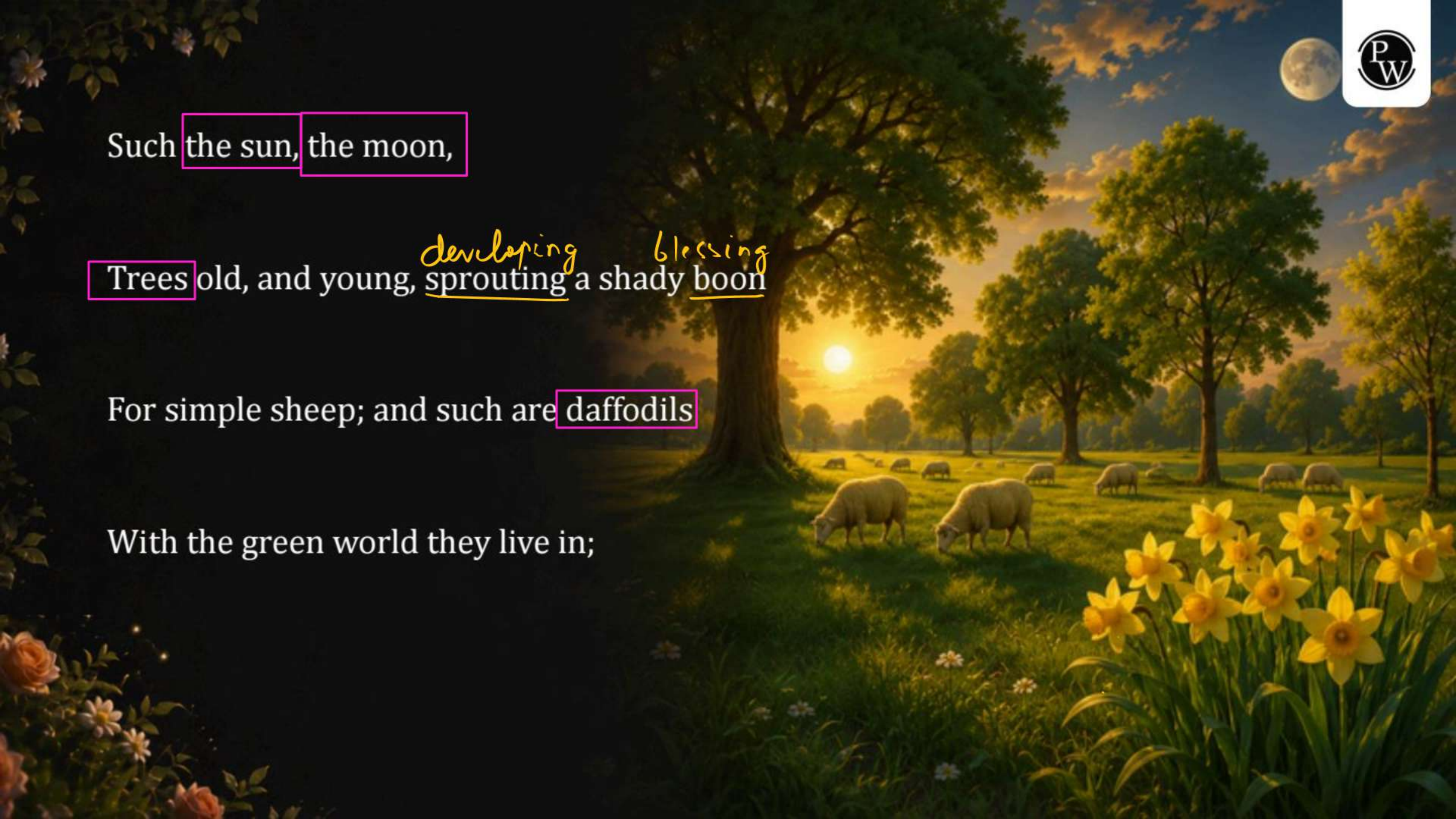


Such the sun, the moon,

Trees old, and young, *developing* *blessing*
sprouting a shady boon

For simple sheep; and such are daffodils

With the green world they live in;



and clear rills

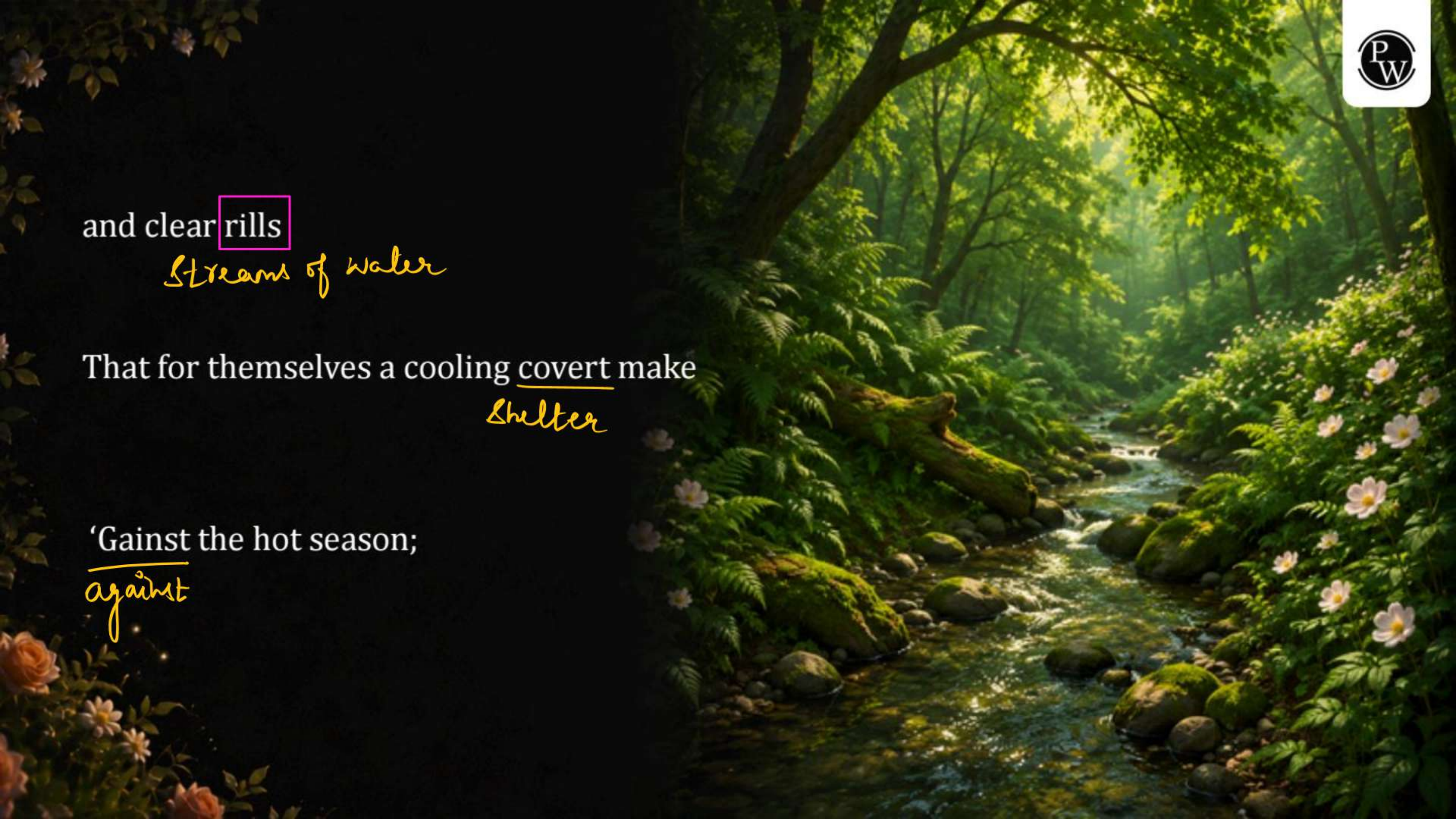
Streams of water

That for themselves a cooling covert make

Shelter

'Gainst the hot season;

against



the mid forest brake,

thick bushes

filled

Rich with a sprinkling of fair musk-rose

वेसि-पि

blooms;

scattered

flowers



greatness of end of some inspiring people
death; fate

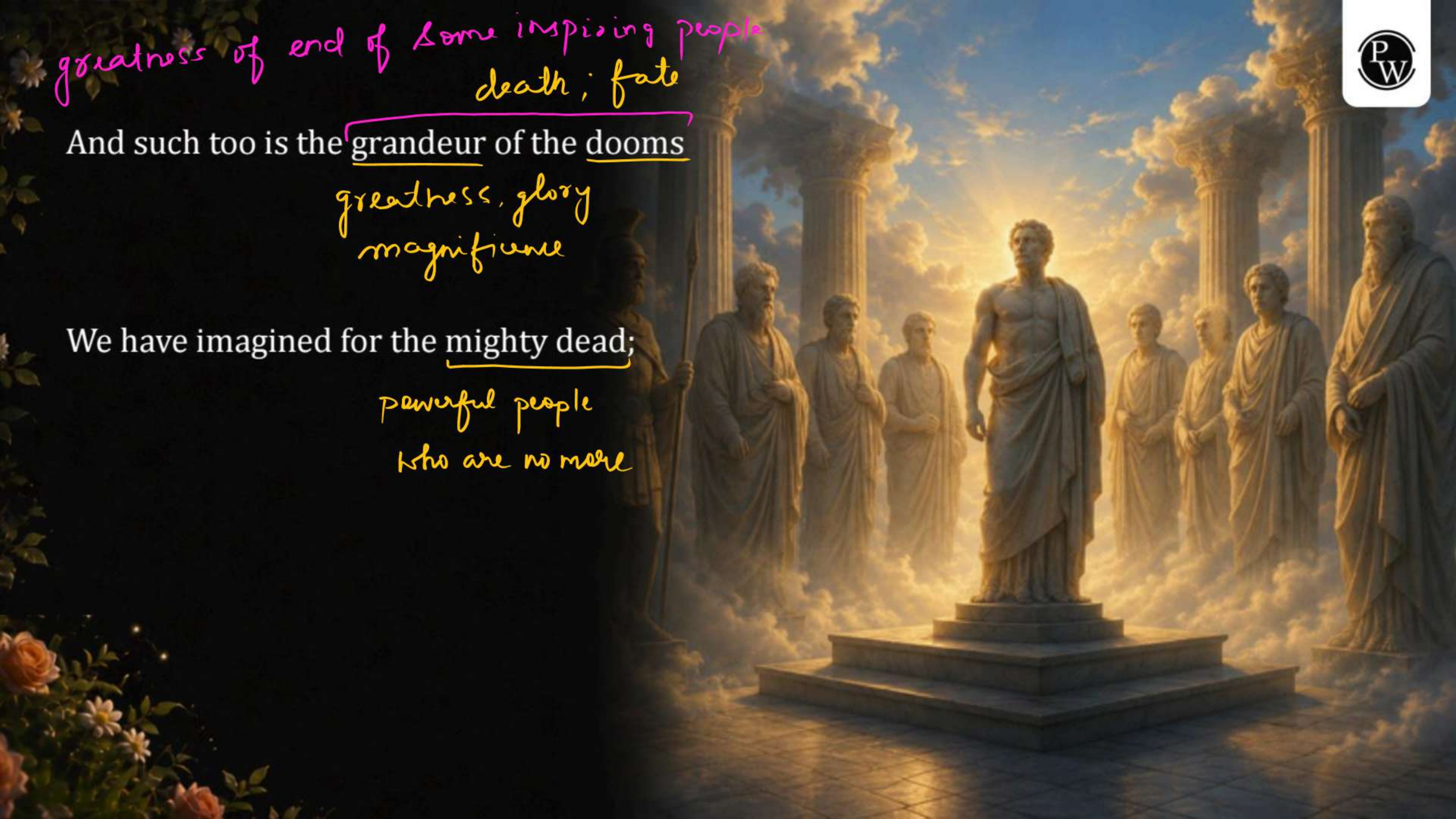


And such too is the grandeur of the dooms

greatness, glory
magnificence

We have imagined for the mighty dead;

powerful people
who are no more



All lovely tales that we have heard or read;

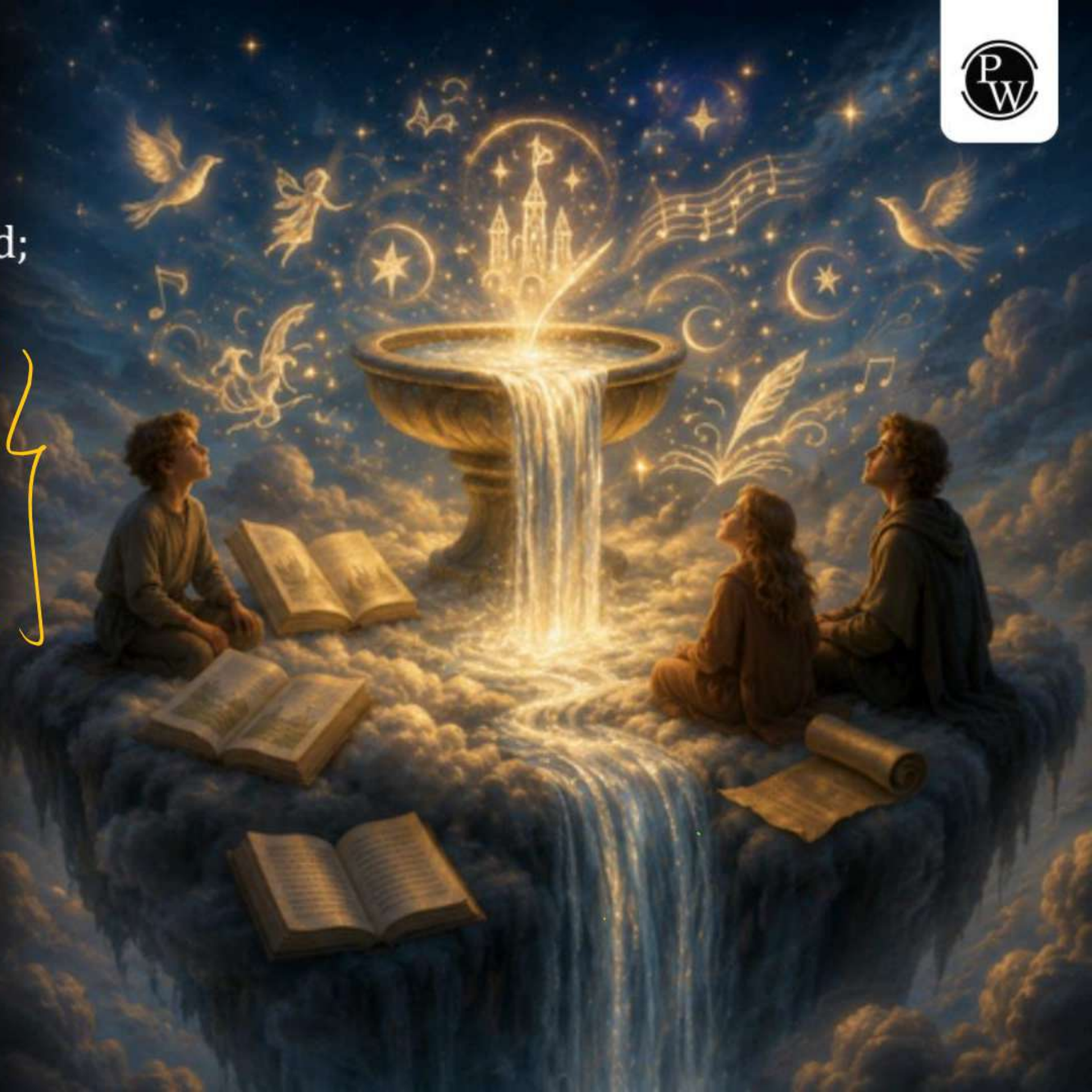
An endless fountain of immortal drink,

शेदिरि nectar; अमृत

Pouring unto us from the heaven's brink.

upon

edge



TONE:

- Optimistic, lyrical

THEME:

- Eternal Beauty, hope

MESSAGE:

- Beauty provides eternal joy, solace and inspiration.



SUMMARY



- **Everlasting Joy:** A thing of beauty brings eternal joy and never fades.
- **Source of Peace:** It provides a peaceful haven, fostering sweet dreams, health, and comfort.
- **Relief from Hardships:**
 - Beauty lifts our spirits, helping us overcome sadness and despair.
 - It inspires us to stay connected to the earth despite sadness and hardships.
 - It helps to clear away the gloom and darkness from our spirits.

- **Examples from Nature:**
 - Sun, moon, trees, daffodils—symbols of everlasting beauty.
 - Small streams and shady forests offer coolness and serenity.
- **Historical Grandeur:** The majesty of historical figures and their stories adds to the world's beauty.
- **Immortal Nourishment:** Beauty is like an endless, divine source, continuously refreshing the human spirit.
- **Lasting Impact:** Though moments are fleeting, beauty leaves a permanent impression on us.

DIFFICULT WORDS



- **bower** : a pleasant place in the shade under trees
- **morrow** : the next day; tomorrow
- **wreathing** : flowers or leaves twisted or woven together into a circle worn on the head as a crown
- **spite** : malice; cause pain
- **despondence** : loss of hope; dejection
- **dearth** : scarcity; lack of something
- **gloomy** : sad

- **pall** : a thick dark cloud of something
- **sprouting** : to appear; to develop something
- **boon** : blessing
- **rills** : small streams
- **covert** : an area of thick low bushes and trees where animals can hide
- **brake** : a thick mass of ferns
- **grandeur** : splendor
- **brink** : extreme edge

Difficult Expressions, Meanings and Symbolism

“Some shape of beauty”

- Meaning: Various forms of beauty in nature and art.
- Symbolism: Represents the eternal presence of beauty in life.

“flowery band”

- Meaning: The pleasant and refreshing elements of nature that connect us to happiness.
- Symbolism: Represents the eternal joy that beauty brings to life.

“pall”

- Meaning: A covering that darkens or hides something.
- Symbolism: Represents sadness, suffering, and despair that beauty helps to overcome.

POETIC DEVICES



1. Alliteration

2. Metaphor

3. Anaphora

4. Imagery

5. Anti-thesis (opposite words placed together in a sentence)

A thing of beauty is a joy forever
 Its loveliness increases, it will never
 Pass into nothingness; but will keep
 A bower quiet for us, and a sleep
 Full of sweet dreams, and health, and quiet
 breathing.

Anti-
thesis

Therefore, on every morrow, are we
 wreathing *Metaphor*

A flowery band to bind us to the earth,

Spite of despondence, of the inhuman dearth

Anaphora
Of noble natures, of the gloomy days,

Of all the unhealthy and o'er-darkened ways

Made for our searching: yes, in spite of all,

Some shape of beauty moves away the pall

Alliteration

From our dark spirits. Such the sun, the moon,
 Trees old, and young, sprouting a shady boon
 For simple sheep; and such are daffodils
 With the green world they live in; and clear
 rills

That for themselves a cooling covert make.

Against the hot season; the mid forest brake,

Rich with a sprinkling of fair musk-rose

blooms; *Imagery, Enjambment*

And such too is the grandeur of the dooms

We have imagined for the mighty dead;

All lovely tales that we have heard or read;

An endless fountain of immortal drink *→ Metaphor*

Pouring unto us from the heaven's brink.



MCQ'S



Q1. What is the message of the poem?

- A) Beauty never fades**
- B) Beauty lifts spirits high**
- C) Beauty is a joy forever**
- ✓ D) All these**

Q2. Write the phrase which means 'it is immortal'.

A) It will never fade

✓ B) It will never pass into nothingness

C) It will never cease

D) It will keep giving happiness for a longer time

Q3. What is a bower?

- A) A river
- B) A stream
- C) A big tree
- ✓ D) A shady tree

Q4. What image does the poet use to convey that beauty is everlasting?

A) A bower quiet for us

B) Some shape of beauty

✓ C) Endless fountain of joy

D) Sprouting a shady boon

Q5. 'Clear rills' are the—

A) Clean windows

✓ B) Streams of clear water

C) Clear thoughts

D) Clear solutions



NCERT QUESTIONS



✓ Q1. List the things of beauty mentioned in the poem.

✓ Q2. List the things that cause suffering and pain.

✓ Q3. What does the line, 'Therefore are we wreathing a flowery band to bind us to earth' suggest to you? ★ ★

✓ Q4. What makes human beings love life in spite of troubles and sufferings?

✓ Q5. Why is 'grandeur' associated with the 'mighty dead'? ★ ★ ★

✓ Q6. Do we experience things of beauty only for short moments or do they make a lasting impression on us?

✓ Q7. What image does the poet use to describe the beautiful bounty of the earth? ★ ★



IMPORTANT QUESTIONS



IMPORTANT QUESTIONS



Q1. Do we experience things of beauty only for short moments or do they make a lasting impression? Explain.

Q2. In the poem 'A Thing of Beauty', how is grandeur connected with the mighty dead?

Q3. What does the line, 'Therefore are we wreathing a flowery band to bind us to earth' suggest to you?

Q4. Based on what Keats' suggests in 'A Thing of Beauty,' how can recognising the lasting value of beauty help someone in the real world cope with challenges or difficulties?

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(ii) State whether the given statement is True or False, with reference to the extract.

The paths we follow are often not worthy of our noble nature.

(iii) The use of the word 'dearth' creates a powerful image of

(iv) Complete the following sentence appropriately:

We wreath for ourselves a flowery band every morrow because

(v) Based on the rhyme scheme in lines 4 and 5, which of the following word will rhyme with 'days' and 'ways'?

A) craze

B) pays

C) haste

D) waste

(vi) The lack of punctuation at the end of line 3 in the extract is to:

- A) create a sense of continuity and flow that connects it with the fourth line.
- B) encourage the reader to understand grammar.
- C) forewarn the reader of gloomy days ahead.
- D) keep us connected to this earth.



ANSWERS



Q1. Do we experience things of beauty only for short moments or do they make a lasting impression? Explain.

According to Keats, beauty is not temporary. It stays with us and keeps growing in value. He clearly says:

“A thing of beauty is a joy forever / Its loveliness increases, it will never / Pass into nothingness...”

So, beautiful things leave a lasting impression because:

- they remain in our memory,
- they give peace and comfort,
- they provide hope and happiness even during difficult times.

Q2. In the poem 'A Thing of Beauty', how is grandeur connected with the mighty dead?

Keats connects grandeur with the mighty dead through the noble and heroic deeds of great people who have passed away. He says:

“And such too is the grandeur of the dooms / We have imagined for the mighty dead...”

Meaning:

- Even after their death, their heroic lives and sacrifices are remembered.
- We create glorious stories, legends, and honour around them.
- This imagination becomes a thing of beauty, inspiring humanity.

Q3. What does the line, 'Therefore are we wreathing a flowery band to bind us to earth' suggest to you?

This line suggests that every day we try to connect ourselves to life by focusing on beautiful things.

Keats says:

"Therefore, on every morrow, are we wreathing / A flowery band to bind us to the earth..."

It implies:

- Life contains sorrow and disappointment,
- but beauty (nature, good memories, noble deeds) becomes like a "flowery band"
- and keeps us emotionally attached to the world, stopping us from falling into hopelessness.

Q4. Based on what Keats' suggests in 'A Thing of Beauty,' how can recognising the lasting value of beauty help someone in the real world cope with challenges or difficulties?

In real life, people face:

- depression,
- loneliness,
- failures,
- negativity around them.
- Keats says even in spite of despondence and gloomy days, beauty removes darkness:
- "Some shape of beauty moves away the pall / From our dark spirits."
- So recognising beauty helps because:
- It gives mental peace
- It creates hope and positivity
- It refreshes the mind like "sweet dreams" and "quiet breathing"
- It motivates a person to keep moving forward
- It becomes a source of strength when life feels harsh
- In short, beauty becomes a psychological support system in hard times.

(v) Based on the rhyme scheme in lines 4 and 5, which of the following word will rhyme with 'days' and 'ways'?

A) craze

B) pays

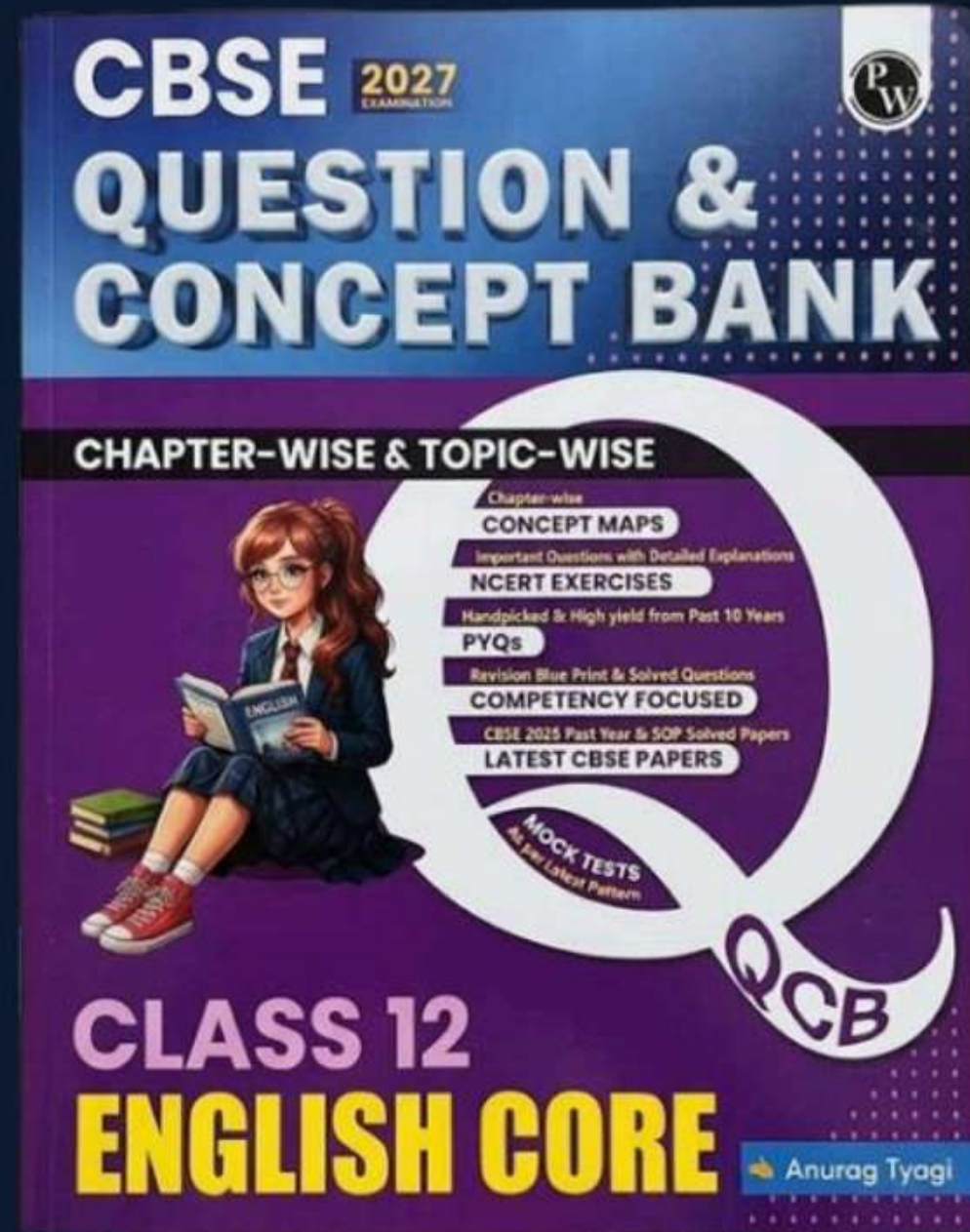
C) haste

D) waste

(vi) The lack of punctuation at the end of line 3 in the extract is to:

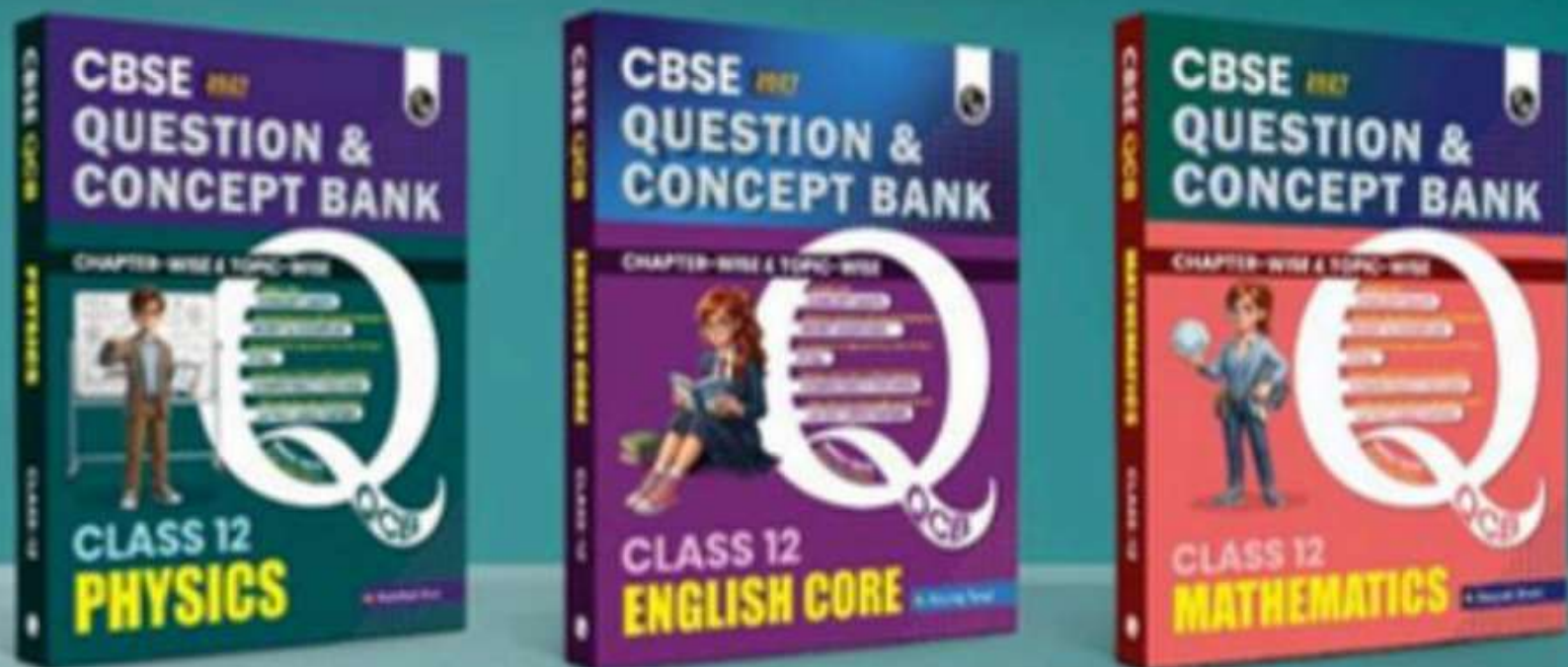
- A) create a sense of continuity and flow that connects it with the fourth line.
- B) encourage the reader to understand grammar.
- C) forewarn the reader of gloomy days ahead.
- D) keep us connected to this earth.

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